School Council Meeting Minutes

School: Silverheights Public School

Date & Time: April 13, 2022, 6:00-8:00 pm

Location: Virtual Google Meet

"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools.

They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.

Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."

Ontario Ministry of Education

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome & Introduction** Introduction of new members Sign attendance sheet	15 mins	Chair (Ling Tam)
	Review & approval of current agenda - School website is up-to-date		
	Review & approval of previous meeting minutes - School website needs minutes for Jan & Feb 2022 to be posted		
2	**Business Arising from the Minutes**	5 mins	Council Members
3	**Old Business / Updates**	5 mins	Council Members
4	**News**		
	WRAPSC - See attachment for summary & links from April meeting.	5 mins	Assembly Rep (Amy Pharoh)
	PIC - See attachment for summary & links from April meeting. - ***ACTION: JASON/CAROLINA - Please identify if there are any volunteer opportunities that Silverheights parents can fulfill in order to support the school community. Specifics on role & requirements for entry to the school building etc. for consideration at the next council meeting in May.***	5 mins	Assembly Rep (Amy Pharoh)
	~~Student Updates - Vacant~~	~~5 mins~~	~~Student Rep~~

	Teacher Updates ● Spirit committee has held several events (Super Me Day, Stuffie Day) & more planned (Earth Day). ● Fire drill was completed & will run again this Spring ● Ace class running the coffee cart (coffee/baked goods cart for teachers, everything $1) ● Intermural sports underway ● Collapsing of the cohorts has allow interclass mingling ● Return of Track & Field; potential field trip to Jacob Hespeler ● Teachers taking their classes outside now that season has started. ● Q: Previously, school has hosted a bike safety day. Will that return? A: Previously run by Eric Walker, should be first point of contact. ● Q: Historically, Gr.7 field trip planning starts in the fall but COVID has derailed field trip planning. Currently no plans underway but board has started permitting field trips again. Field trip requests starting to be submitted & will need to be evaluated based on equity & accessibility.	10 mins	Teacher Rep (Chad Moffat)
	Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association https://silverheightsneighbourhood.com/programs/ ● See the SNA website & Facebook page for ongoing updates. ● Spring in-person programs underway ● Online summer camp registration starts May 7. Create your family account before registration goes LIVE.	10 mins	Community Rep (Lori Ryan-Da Cunha)
5	**Principal's Report** ● Student enrollment for 2022-2023 has increased & will likely continue to increase as Kindie enrollment continues through end of summer. ● Hiring 2 new educators & more hires are likely. ● Field trips now permitted by the board ● Track & Field now permitted by the board	10 mins	Principal (Jason Stere)

	● Staffing shortages being experienced across the board; Occasional Teachers (OTs) are in limited supply. ● Daily COVID cases being reported via School Day, based on ***voluntary disclosure*** when parents report via attendance line. ● School staff is appreciative of continued support & patience from the community as resources continue to be strained. ● Gr.8 Year-end returning this year with in-person celebrations but school is looking to redefine & reframe this milestone with emphasis on inclusivity & equity (moving away from rewards & recognitions). Allowing Gr.8 students to participate in the vision planning & execution to promote inclusion & equity in the year-end celebrations. Format & details yet to be announced but will be shared in the coming weeks. School may sending out a Google Form to survey school community to help develop new vision for these celebrations. ● School pictures were previously scheduled but keeps getting postponed due to COVID protocols. Updates will come through School Day. ● Ongoing regular Hawks Reach newsletter from P/VP to the Silverheights staff; includes Prof. Development, highlights of the staff meetings, topics (inclusions & equity). ● Q: Parent commented that the staff list on the Silverheights PS website is not accurate & lines of communication to child's education team is confusing. A: By default, parent should contact the child's homeroom teacher, who would then forward to the teaching team as needed.		
	Equity Connections ● None this month	5 mins	Vice-Principal (Carolina Miranda)
6	**Financial Report** February 2022 = $10,630.52 April 2022 = TBD Grants: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/4690-School-Generated-Funds.pdf - Expired Award (Mar 25): Tim Walker Memorial Award was established in 2006 in honour of the contributions made by this	10 min	Treasurer

	secondary school WRDSB teacher to education & the environment. - The Award provides funding to support environmentally-focused projects that promote environmental benefits to a school and/or community. - Award of $2,000 divided between up to four recipients, in equal amounts, to assist them in completing their projects. - No action - revisit in 2022-2023 school year. PIC Grant - All School Councils automatically receive $500 from the MOE for events or activities to "engage parents in their child's education." Funds must be spent between Sept. 1 & June 30. - No action - revisit in 2022-2023 school year. PRO Grant - These grants encourage parent engagement at the local, regional & provincial levels & are designed to support parents in identifying barriers to parent engagement in their own community & to find local solutions to involve more parents in support of student achievement & well-being. - No action - revisit in 2022-2023 school year.		
7	**Fundraising Committee** Goal-setting ● Teacher wish list generated in the fall. ● Over $8000 approved by Council on 2021-2022 wish list ● Goal to replenish coffers for 2022-2023 wish list Ongoing fundraising initiatives - Mabels Labels (Kindie Classrooms, ongoing) - Domino's Pizza (Every Wednesday, $1/pizza to Silverheights, Promo code: CARE, ongoing). Ling follow-up with owner to clarify duration of this fundraiser & current balance for 2021-2022. - NEW!! Oliver's Labels (http://www.oliverslabels.com/silverheightsps, no expiration)	10 mins	Subcommittee Rep:

	- NEW!! Plantables (https://plantables.ca/store/) To date: 9 Orders = $49.50 raised - Fundscript: Info package received & Ling currently in process of registering. This fundraiser may be pushed to 2022-2023 year) - Q: Can donations be made directly to the school? A: The Waterloo Education Foundation Inc. (WEFI) is a registered charitable foundation, which operates through the Board & is managed by a Board of Directors (https://www.wrdsb.ca/wefi/). Funds can be directed to Silverheights PS using the drop-down menu under Donation Details – Fund. - ACTION: School Day announcement reminding parents & community members that they can support Silverheights PS by volunteering, participating in fundraiser campaigns (such as Olivers Labels and Plantables) or donations directly through WEFI (note that since WEFI is a charitable organization, tax receipts are applicable). Special Event initiatives - Family movie nights - Pizza days - Smencils - Candy grams - Q: Is there any plan to resume these special event initiatives? There is still some stock of smencils available for sale if School admin allows this initiative. - Q: Can pizza days resume? Parent volunteers are available to help with pizza days, if/when this resumes.		
8	**New Business**	30 min	Council Members
9	**Questions & Answer Period**	10 mins	Council Members
10	**Next Meeting Date:**	May 11, 2022 **6:30 PM**	Virtual Meet
	Agenda Items for Next Meeting	5 mins	Council Members

11	**Adjournment**	HH:MM	N/A

Notes:

MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education

PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)

PRO – Parents Reaching Out

SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)

WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

Attendance Sheet				
	Role	**Name**	**Email**	**Phone**
1	Chair	Ling Tam	silverheightscouncil@gmail.com	519-546-3155
2	Secretary	Ling Tam		
3	Principal	Regrets		
4	Vice-Principal	Carolina Miranda		
5	Teacher Rep	Chad Moffat		
6	WRAPSC / PIC Rep	Amy Pharoah		
7	Community Rep	Lori Ryan-Da Cunha - Regrets		
8		Treasure Kroft		
9		Alison Chong		
10		Shian Mohammod		
11		Jenn Latour		
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WRAPSC Update – April 2022

Tips: https://www.stswr.ca/walkzone/home-support/

Our school: https://www.stswr.ca/wp-content/uploads/ParkingMap_Silverheights.png

Elementary schools in our region: https://www.stswr.ca/walkzone/maps/

Leslie_maxwell@stswr.ca or 519-744-7575 x 224 to have an advocate for change to study your area

Board Policy 6010: Dress Code

Dress code draft to be presented to the board: religion or ethnic background, gender inequality, transgender, nonbinary, and gender nonconforming (forced into strict ideas of gender), education of staff to changes in policy, principal education, "being dress coded" by unliked students vs. liked students, students not sent home for inappropriate language

Guiding Principles: dress rests with students and parents, dress includes more than clothes, policy is student centered, and violations should not affect students' overall school record

-other: options (turn cannabis shirt inside out)

-clarification: safe clothes for gym

Draft policy still yet to be approved; when approved, will be posted to board website.

Walking to School

Tips for parents on coaching your child about walking to school, walking in your community, etc:

https://www.stswr.ca/walkzone/home-support/

Parking Map for the parents of our school:
https://www.stswr.ca/wp-content/uploads/ParkingMap_Silverheights.png

What volunteer opportunities would parents like to have in their schools?

PIC Family Engagement Series:

Honey I Wrecked the Kids book:
https://www.amazon.ca/Honey-Wrecked-Kids-Alyson-Schafer/dp/1443427780

Podcast: https://alysonschafer.com/podcasts/

Twitter: https://twitter.com/alysonschafer and Facebook

TEDx Talk: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XUm86kTSFQE

4 Types of Misbehavior: Undue attention (positive connection is vital though), Undue Power, Revenge, and Inadequacy

Talking to Kids about Racism:

https://pjlibrary.org/beyond-books/pjblog/june-2020/resources-for-talking-to-kids-about-racism

https://kidshealth.org/en/parents/talk-about-race.html

https://www.commonsensemedia.org/articles/how-to-talk-with-kids-about-racism-and-racial-violence

https://www.parents.com/parenting/better-parenting/teaching-tolerance/talking-about-race-with-kids/

Books for Kids: *Malala Yousafzai, Different Just Like Me, I Never Forget a Face*

Book for Parents: Me and White Supremacy by Layla Saad
https://www.amazon.ca/Me-White-Supremacy-Combat-Ancestor/dp/1728209803

WRDSB Lunch and Learn Psychology Series:
https://www.wrdsb.ca/blog/2022/04/01/april-lunch-and-learn-sessions-for-parents-and-caregivers-2/

Wed. April. 20 from 12:15-12:45 When Your Child Doesn't Want to Go to School

Wed. April 27 The Development of Self-Regulation & Co-Regulation

Previous WRDSB Psychology series:

Mindfulness Meditation exercises including Forgiveness and Kindness Meditation: Audio Recordings - Mindfulness Center (virginia.edu)

Media Resources for Families:

https://www.commonsensemedia.org/

https://www.healthychildren.org/English/family-life/Media/Pages/How-to-Make-a-Family-Media-Use-Plan.aspx

https://mediasmarts.ca/parents

https://www.childrenandscreens.com/

https://parents.ygam.org/

Business & Education Partnership of Waterloo Region (BEP)

Free Virtual Events for Grades 7-8. Must sign up.:

April 27 at 6:30 if they are interested in an environmental profession (BEP Waterloo Region).

https://www.bepwr.ca/blog/explore-your-future-caring-for-the-earth

May 11 at 6:30 Business Builders https://www.bepwr.ca/blog/world-of-choices-21-22